

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

Page 27 - The Age of Chaucer (Part 4)

Q1. Chaucer was brought into direct touch with Italian culture during the days of what?

- A. The late Renaissance
- B. The early Renaissance
- C. The Industrial Revolution
- D. The Protestant Reformation

Answer: B

Q2. Which two Italian writers might Chaucer have met?

- A. Dante and Machiavelli
- B. Petrarch and Boccaccio
- C. Galileo and Leonardo da Vinci
- D. Michelangelo and Raphael

Answer: B

Q3. Who was Chaucer's special patron whose banishment led to Chaucer falling on evil days?

- A. King Richard II
- B. John of Gaunt
- C. The Duke of Clarence
- D. Wat Tyler

Answer: B

Q4. Which king's accession placed Chaucer beyond want by granting him a royal pension?

- A. Edward III
- B. Richard II
- C. Henry IV
- D. Henry V

Answer: C

Q5. Where was Chaucer buried?

- A. St. Paul's Cathedral
- B. A part of Westminster Abbey later known as the Poets' Corner

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

C. The Tower of London

D. Canterbury Cathedral

Answer: B

Q6. Chaucer's education as a poet is described as being two-fold. What were the two parts?

A. From poetry and from prose

B. From religion and from science

C. From literature and from life

D. From England and from France

Answer: C

Q7. How does Chaucer describe his study habits in 'The House of Fame'?

A. Poring over books till he was completely dazed

B. Never reading, only observing

C. Paying others to read for him

D. Only reading during the day

Answer: A

Q8. Like Shakespeare and Milton, Chaucer was not just a bookman, he was what?

A. A visionary

B. A religious reformer

C. A man of the world and of affairs

D. A successful farmer

Answer: C

Q9. What three periods is Chaucer's literary career conveniently divided into?

A. English, Spanish, and German

B. French, Italian, and English

C. Latin, Greek, and English

D. Welsh, Irish, and Scottish

Answer: B

Q10. What formed the favorite reading of cultivated society during Chaucer's youth?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- A. English histories
- B. Latin theological treatises
- C. French poetry and romance
- D. Italian sonnets

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

Page 28 - The Age of Chaucer (Part 5)

Q1. Which of the following is an early work of Chaucer done on French models?

- A. The Canterbury Tales
- B. The Boke of the Duchesse
- C. Troylus and Cryseyde
- D. The House of Fame

Answer: B

Q2. During his second period (1370-84), Chaucer's work was influenced by masters from which country?

- A. France
- B. Italy
- C. Germany
- D. Spain

Answer: B

Q3. Chaucer's 'The House of Fame' clearly owes much to which Italian master?

- A. Boccaccio
- B. Petrarch
- C. Dante
- D. Machiavelli

Answer: C

Q4. What is the title of Chaucer's longest single poem?

- A. The Canterbury Tales
- B. Troylus and Cryseyde
- C. Legende of Good Women
- D. Roman de la Rose

Answer: B

Q5. In his third period, what does it mean that Chaucer becomes 'English'?

- A. He writes exclusively about English history
- B. He refuses to read foreign literature

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

C. Instead of being merely imitative, he becomes independent

D. He creates a new English alphabet

Answer: C

Q6. Which work is considered Chaucer's most famous and characteristic work from his final period?

A. The Canterbury Tales

B. The Boke of the Duchesse

C. The House of Fame

D. Troylus and Cryseyde

Answer: A

Q7. What is the structure of The Canterbury Tales?

A. A single long epic poem about a war

B. A collection of stories fitted into a general framework

C. A series of unconnected sonnets

D. A strictly historical account of kings

Answer: B

Q8. Where do the pilgrims in The Canterbury Tales meet?

A. The Tabard Inn in Southwark

B. Westminster Abbey

C. The Tower of London

D. Windsor Castle

Answer: A

Q9. Where are the pilgrims in The Canterbury Tales bound?

A. Rome

B. Jerusalem

C. The shrine of St. Thomas a Becket at Canterbury

D. The royal palace in London

Answer: C

Q10. Who was the host of the Tabard Inn?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- A. Geoffrey Chaucer
- B. John of Gaunt
- C. Harry Bailly
- D. St. Thomas a Becket

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

Page 29 - The Age of Chaucer (Part 6)

Q1. What is the proposal made by Harry Bailly to the pilgrims?

- A. That they race to Canterbury
- B. That each member shall tell two tales on the way and two on the way back
- C. That they must all pray in silence
- D. That they take turns driving the horses

Answer: B

Q2. What is the prize for the pilgrim who tells the best tale?

- A. A free pardon from the Pope
- B. A gold coin
- C. A supper on their return to the Tabard Inn
- D. The title of Knight

Answer: C

Q3. In which section of the work is this plan explained?

- A. The Epilogue
- B. The Prologue
- C. The Knight's Tale
- D. The Miller's Tale

Answer: B

Q4. Which of the following professions represents the military class in the prologue?

- A. A prioress, a monk, a friar
- B. A knight, a squire, and a yeoman
- C. A lawyer and a physician
- D. A franklin and a merchant

Answer: B

Q5. Which character is described as a well-to-do west-country cloth-maker named Alison?

- A. The Prioress
- B. The Nun

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- C. The Wife of Bath
- D. The Tapestry Maker

Answer: C

Q6. Broadly speaking, what social class is the company of pilgrims limited to?

- A. The royal family
- B. The middle classes
- C. The peasantry
- D. The criminal class

Answer: B

Q7. How are the characters in the Prologue described regarding their quality?

- A. They are completely unbelievable
- B. They are not individualized at all
- C. They are individualized yet have a thoroughly typical quality
- D. They are all based on Greek gods

Answer: C

Q8. How many tales was each pilgrim supposed to tell in total according to the original plan?

- A. One
- B. Two
- C. Four
- D. Ten

Answer: C

Q9. How many tales did Chaucer actually complete?

- A. Over a hundred
- B. The entire planned amount
- C. Merely a fragment of twenty-four tales
- D. Only one tale

Answer: C

Q10. Why do the completed tales differ so widely in character from one another?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- A. Because Chaucer forgot his original style
- B. Because he was guided by a sense of dramatic propriety based on the teller
- C. Because different authors wrote them
- D. Because they were written centuries apart

Answer: B

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

Page 30 - The Age of Chaucer (Part 7)

Q1. Which characters tell coarse farcical stories?

- A. The Knight and the Clerk
- B. The Miller and the Reeve
- C. The Prioress and the Nun
- D. The Lawyer and the Physician

Answer: B

Q2. In The Canterbury Tales, how many of the tales are original in their theme?

- A. All of them
- B. About half of them
- C. In no case are the tales original in theme
- D. Only the Knight's Tale

Answer: C

Q3. From what sources does Chaucer take his raw material for the tales?

- A. Only English folk stories
- B. Exclusively from the Bible
- C. All sorts of literature: Latin, French, and Italian
- D. Only from personal experiences

Answer: C

Q4. What is considered Chaucer's finest work as a narrative poet?

- A. The Miller's Tale
- B. The Knight's Tale
- C. The Clerk's Tale
- D. The Wife of Bath's Tale

Answer: B

Q5. Upon whose work is the Knight's Tale based?

- A. Dante
- B. Petrarch

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

C. Boccaccio (the Teseide)

D. Virgil

Answer: C

Q6. Who are the two young cousins of royal blood in the Knight's Tale?

A. Romeo and Mercutio

B. Palamon and Arcite

C. Theseus and Creon

D. Lancelot and Gawain

Answer: B

Q7. Who do the two cousins see walking in the garden that causes them to become rivals in love?

A. Helena

B. Juliet

C. Emily

D. Guinevere

Answer: C

Q8. How does Duke Theseus decide to settle the dispute between the two cousins over Emily?

A. By exiling them both

B. By drawing lots

C. By executing them both

D. By a great tournament where each collects a hundred knights

Answer: D

Q9. Who wins the hand of Emily at the end of the story?

A. Arcite

B. Palamon

C. Theseus

D. Neither, she refuses both

Answer: B

Q10. Nominally, the Knight's Tale is a story of the heroic age of Greece, but what is its actual atmosphere?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- A. A realistic depiction of ancient Athens
- B. An accurate historical record of Rome
- C. An idealized picture of the fast-vanishing middle ages, steeped in chivalry
- D. A futuristic science fiction setting

Answer: C

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

Page 31 - The Age of Chaucer (Conclusion)

Q1. Was Chaucer considered a poet of the people?

- A. Yes, he wrote entirely for the lower classes
- B. No, he was a court poet who wrote for cultured readers
- C. Yes, his poetry was sung by peasants
- D. He wrote equally for all classes

Answer: B

Q2. What did Chaucer's audience want to be amused or touched by?

- A. Political manifestos
- B. Comedy, pathos, or romantic sentiment
- C. Scientific discoveries
- D. Religious sermons only

Answer: B

Q3. What kind of topics did Chaucer's audience NOT wish to be disturbed by?

- A. Humorous anecdotes
- B. Romantic poetry
- C. Painful reminders of plagues, famines, and popular discontent
- D. Tales of knightly ethics

Answer: C

Q4. What is significant about Chaucer's mention of the Peasants' Revolt?

- A. He wrote a tragic epic about it
- B. It is only mentioned as a humorous reference in the Nonnes Priestes Tale
- C. He supported the revolt openly in his Prologue
- D. He completely ignored it and never referenced it

Answer: B

Q5. How do we know Chaucer was aware of the religious corruptions of his time?

- A. Through his satiric portraits of churchmen and his study of the poor parson
- B. Because he was excommunicated

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

C. Because he led a rebellion against the Pope

D. He was a wealthy prelate himself

Answer: A

Q6. With whose ideas does Chaucer's sympathetic portrayal of the poor parson align?

A. The Pope's

B. John Wyclif's

C. King Richard's

D. Jack Straw's

Answer: B

Q7. How is Chaucer's general nature described in relation to social reform?

A. He was a fiery revolutionary

B. He was an easy-going, genial, tolerant nature with nothing of the reformer in him

C. He was deeply miserable and pessimistic

D. He was purely a religious zealot

Answer: B

Q8. What is the characteristic tone of Chaucer's poetry?

A. Deep moral outrage

B. Frank pleasure in the good things of life

C. Endless sorrow and tragedy

D. Strict academic instruction

Answer: B

Q9. Which intellectual influence did Chaucer respond readily to?

A. French scholasticism

B. Italian humanism

C. German theology

D. Greek philosophy

Answer: B

Q10. Through Chaucer, what kind of spirit first expresses itself in English poetry?

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 6)

- A. The strict dogmatic spirit of the church
- B. The revolutionary spirit of the peasants
- C. The free secular spirit of Italian humanism
- D. The military spirit of the crusades

Answer: C